MAI MOHAMED HELMY

ART & DESIGN TEACHER CANDIDATE | VISUAL ARTIST | CREATIVE WORKSHOP FACILITATOR

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Fine Arts graduate and practising visual artist with 28 years of professional art experience (since 1998) and over four years facilitating structured art-based activities with children, young people and families (since 2022). Independently plans and leads individual and group workshops; adapts materials, pace and instructions for diverse developmental and learning needs, including ADHD and autism. Combines painting, drawing, printmaking and mixed-media expertise with practical experience in positive behaviour support, progress observation and safeguarding-related child-protection work. Seeking to bring inclusive, skills-rich creative education to an international-school Art & Design classroom.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Independent Art-Based Workshop Facilitator & Art Therapy Practitioner | 2022–Present

Independent practice | Cairo

- Plan and lead individual and group creative activities for children, adolescents and families, with objectives, materials, sequenced instructions and reflective follow-up.
- Differentiate activities by age and learner need; use visual instructions, shorter tasks, alternative media, gradual challenge and positive reinforcement.

Art & Behaviour Support / Creative Facilitation Practitioner | 2022–2024

Al-Dar Center for Psychological Support | Cairo

- Independently designed, delivered and supervised art-based sessions for children, including those with ADHD, autism and attention or participation difficulties.
- Developed individual session plans in coordination with specialists; reviewed progression against each child's earlier work rather than comparing children with peers.
- Helped build demand for art-based workshops and sessions at the centre; supported families and multidisciplinary collaboration.

Children's Creative Workshop Facilitator & Family Support | 2024 (6 months)

Child Protection Centre, Egyptian Association for Community Building & Protection of Children from Violence | UNICEF-partner programme

- Facilitated paid creative-group activities for children affected by violence, adversity and displacement, emphasising safe participation and self-expression.
- Completed training in child-protection case-study writing and electronic reporting forms used in UNICEF-related programme activities.

Community & Student Art Workshop Facilitator | 2022, 2025

University student workshops (BUE & AAST), 2022 | Children's Cancer Hospital Egypt 57357, 2025

- Led emotion-expression activities for university students and age-adapted creative workshops supporting confidence, choice and self-expression for children aged approximately 6–16 at Hospital 57357.

Professional Visual Artist & Printmaker | 1998–Present

Independent studio practice | Egypt and international exhibitions

- Exhibiting artist skilled in drawing, painting, relief and intaglio printmaking, screen printing, lithography and mixed media; recipient of Egypt's State Artistic Dedication Grant for four consecutive years.

SELECTED WORKSHOP EXAMPLES

Focus through clay and structured pattern-making | **Ages 7–10**

Attention and engagement

Designed a short, progressively structured exercise arranging small clay pieces into patterns, with complexity increased for older learners through clay-coiling tasks.

Painting on water for emotional expression | **Ages 15–20**

Creative reflection

Facilitated a water-based image-making activity followed by discussion of emerging forms and personal interpretation, encouraging self-expression without prescribing one correct artistic outcome.

Colour, confidence and self-expression | **Ages 6–16**

Children's Cancer Hospital Egypt 57357, 2025

Used age-appropriate colouring activities to invite expression of feelings and concerns in a supportive setting, with choice, reassurance and encouragement.

ART & DESIGN EXPERTISE

Drawing, sketching and shading • Colour theory • Acrylic and gouache • Water-based inks and watercolour • Relief / intaglio printmaking • Screen printing • Lithography • Cyanotype • Monoprint • Collage and mixed media • Mosaic • Clay and basic sculpture • Water marbling • Art from recycled materials

LEARNING DESIGN, INCLUSION AND SAFEGUARDING

Workshop and activity planning • Step-by-step demonstrations • Activity differentiation • Visual and simplified instructions • Positive reinforcement • SEND-aware creative facilitation • Progress observations and individual artwork review • Family and specialist communication • Child-protection documentation awareness • Word, PowerPoint, Canva and Google Classroom

EDUCATION & RELEVANT PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Bachelor of Fine Arts | **1999**

Helwan University | Department of Animation and Book Art

Art Therapy Specialist Preparation Programme | **2022**

Ain Shams University, Faculty of Specific Education / Arts Centre (with collaborating training association) | 180 training hours | Excellent

Applied Behaviour Analysis (ABA) & Psychological Disorders | **2022**

Training courses delivered with Ain Shams University's Faculty of Specific Education / Arts Centre | 10 hours each

Healing with the Arts | **2024**

University of Florida-authorised online, non-credit course offered through Coursera

Group Therapy with Psychodrama | **2022**

Training attendance | 18 hours

Psychological Counselling Training | **2023**

Course-completion certificates, 2023; supporting documents available upon request

ARTISTIC RECOGNITION & PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

State Grant for Artistic Dedication, Egyptian Ministry of Culture (four consecutive years). Selected exhibitions: Ahmed Shawqi Museum (2026), Mahmoud Mokhtar Museum (2024), Alexandria University Lithography Symposium (2023), Bibliotheca Alexandrina (2023), Montez Gallery, Rome (2021).

Member, Egyptian Art Therapy Association; recognised for participation in Alexandria University's 2023 Lithographic Printing Forum. Available immediately for work in Sheikh Zayed; references on request.